digit TEST LABS

At Digit, we dedicate ourselves to providing reliable and impartial assessments of the latest consumer tech products. Our team handles hundreds of smartphones, laptops, tablets, peripherals, and other devices each year, employing a suite of industry-standard benchmarks and specialised testing equipment to capture consistent, data-driven results. From performance metrics to user experience evaluations, every product faces a rigorous testing process that ensures our readers receive well-rounded insights into how devices truly perform.

All of the above testing efforts culminate into Digit's Zero1 Awards, which are given out to the best performing products of the year, in an effort to remind you of what you should consider buying – if you're the type that has to have the absolute best products. It's also our way of rewarding brands for putting in tonnes of research and development, and coming up with the best-performing products.

HOW WE TEST SMARTPHONES

When reviewing smartphones, we focus on performance, build and design, battery life, display quality, and camera capabilities. We even have specialised tests to gauge how well a smartphone might run AI-driven applications. We run standardised benchmarks to gauge CPU and GPU performance, enabling us to see how devices handle tasks ranging from everyday browsing to resource-intensive gaming. Battery life is assessed through real-world usage scenarios and endurance tests to replicate how readers might use their phones each day. Our display evaluations include brightness tests and colour accuracy measurements, while camera testing combines controlled lighting setups with outdoor shoots to verify how well cameras capture detail and manage varying lighting conditions. This multi-faceted approach provides a balanced view of how a smartphone fares in day-to-day life.

HOW WE TEST LAPTOPS

Our laptop testing protocol examines performance, ergonomics, battery endurance, and thermal management. Processors and graphics components undergo industry-recognised benchmark runs that challenge both single-core and multi-core capabilities, ensuring we capture how laptops handle everything from light productivity to demanding content creation tasks. We also measure battery life using a blend of typical office workloads and entertainment use, giving a realistic indication of how long each laptop will last away from a charger. Thermals and acoustics are closely observed to identify any performance throttling or excess noise during sustained workloads. Finally, we evaluate build quality, keyboard comfort, and port selection, resulting in a thorough overview of each laptop's strengths and potential limitations.